equicenta™ CTM

ALLOGRAFT TISSUE INFORMATION & INSTRUCTIONS FOR USE

PRODUCT IDENTIFICATION & DESCRIPTION

equicenta™ CTM is a cryopreserved allogeneic equine umbilical cord derived connective tissue matrix (Wharton's jelly) suspended in a cryopreservation solution. The allograft is recovered, processed, and packaged using controlled, aseptic procedures in accordance with **FDA CVM GFI #218, #253, and #254**. No terminal sterilization is applied.

INTENDED USE

equicenta™ CTM is intended for use as a cushioning, space-filling connective tissue matrix within and around equine joints, tendons, and ligaments, providing supplemental structural support to soft-tissue spaces. Intended for intra-articular, intra-lesional, or peri-lesional injection in a single **equine patient** on a single occasion by **licensed veterinarians only**.

PACKAGING / STORAGE

Each unit of **equicenta™ CTM** contains 1.5 mL of cryopreserved equine umbilical cord tissue allograft in a sealed inner container (cryovial), placed in a protective pouch and/or outer box. The contents of the cryovial are processed aseptically; the outer packaging and outer vial surface are non-sterile. Product labels identify the product name, tissue ID, expiration date, and storage conditions.

The following items are included in the product package, at a minimum:

- 1 Foil Pouch
- 1 Certificate of Processing
- 1 CTM Suspension IFU
- 1 Cryogenic Vial (containing allograft suspension)
- 1 Set of Supplemental Labels for Patient Documentation

Store at −80 °C or colder until use.

The product is frozen. Upon receipt, promptly transfer the product to a freezer that maintains the recommended storage temperature.

Maintain the product in the frozen state until preparation for thawing.

Once thawed, **use immediately** and do not refreeze.

Do not use the product after the printed expiration date. Please refer to the vial label for the expiration date.

DONOR SCREENING AND TESTING

Donor horses are evaluated according to applicable requirements and internal procedures for disease risk factors and transmissible conditions as per FDA CVM Guidance for Industry #254. Tissue recovery, processing, preservation, packaging, and storage are performed under controlled conditions using aseptic procedures designed to maintain tissue quality and safety. Each allograft unit is assigned a unique identifier to support traceability.

CONTRAINDICATIONS

Do not use in equine patients with known hypersensitivity to DMSO, penicillin G, streptomycin, or amphotericin B.

Do not use in cases of known or suspected active infection at or near the intended injection site.

WARNINGS

Target Species: For use in horses only.

Safety: Not for use in humans.

Storage Safety: Keep out of reach of children.

Handling Risks: Improper storage, handling, or thawing may adversely affect product characteristics.

Single-Use Only: Do not reuse, re-sterilize, or refreeze once thawed.

Product Integrity: Do not use if any packaging component appears damaged, opened, or compromised, or if the product label is missing or illegible.

Expiration: Do not use after the expiration date printed on the product label.

PRECAUTIONS

Clinical Protocol: Use aseptic technique during all handling, preparation, and injection steps.

Verification: Verify patient identity, product identity, lot number, and expiration date prior to use.

Clinical Judgment: The safety of repeated treatment courses in the same horse has not been established; additional treatments should be considered cautiously.

Untested Populations: The product has not been evaluated in breeding, pregnant, or lactating horses, nor has it been tested in donkeys or mules.

Administration Limits: Not intended for intravenous administration.

Pressure: Avoid excessive injection pressure when introducing the product into joint or peri-articular spaces.

Concurrent Use: The safety and performance of concurrent administration with other intra-articular or peri-articular products have not been established.

DIRECTIONS FOR USE

Maintain strict aseptic technique throughout all steps.

1. Preparation and Inspection

- Verify patient identity, product identity, lot number, and expiration date.
- Verify product label for vial size and content.
- Inspect packaging for damage, moisture, or compromised seals.
- Maintain the product in a frozen state (−80°C or colder) until ready to initiate thawing.

2. Thawing Procedure

- Thaw the sealed cryovial at ambient room temperature; the vial may be held in the palms of gloved hands to facilitate the process.

- Do not expose the vial to direct heat sources (e.g., microwaves or hot water baths).
- Allow the product to thaw completely. Once thawed, use immediately and do not refreeze.

3. Dosage, Withdrawal, and Administration

- Prepare the intended injection site using standard aseptic technique for intra-articular, intra-lesional, or peri-lesional injection.
- Visually inspect the thawed product; do not use if the vial is damaged or if visible contamination is present.
- Flick the vial gently to ensure all contents are at the bottom.
- Using a 20 gauge needle and sterile syringe, withdraw the required dose. Do not mix with other products or solutions.
- Dosage is lesion-dependent; **the recommended volume per site is 1.5 mL for joints and ligaments**.
- Slowly inject the product into the target space, avoiding excessive pressure.
- Apply standard post-injection care and discard any unused product.

CHARACTERIZATION & SAFETY

equicenta™ CTM is a microparticulate matrix derived from equine umbilical cord (Wharton's jelly). As with all allogeneic tissue products, potential risks include local inflammatory responses (e.g., pain, swelling, heat, transient synovitis, or effusion); immune or hypersensitivity reactions (including graft-versus-host-type or allergic responses); and a potential risk of infectious disease transmission.

Proteomic analysis identified 2,000+ proteins, including fibrillar collagens and glycosaminoglycans, The product exhibits a low inflammatory cytokine profile.

POTENTIAL ADVERSE EVENTS & REPORTING

Potential adverse events may include, but are not limited to:

- Local inflammatory responses at or near the injection site (e.g., pain, swelling, heat).
- Transient synovitis or effusion in the treated joint, which in controlled studies has been observed as a self-limiting transudative synovitis resolving within several days.
- Infection at the injection or implantation site.
- Immune or hypersensitivity reactions, including graft-versus-host-type or allergic responses.

Reporting: Veterinarians Monitor patients according to standard clinical practice. Report suspected adverse reactions to **Equine Performance Labs at (888) 979-3625 or email adverseevents@equineperformancelabs.com.**

INFORMATION FOR HORSE OWNERS

Owners should be informed that **equicenta™ CTM** is an allogeneic tissue product. Potential side effects include transient pain, swelling, or inflammation at the injection site, and rarely, joint infection. Allograft use carries inherent risks, such as the potential transmission of infectious agents or immune/allergic reactions. **Advise owners to contact their veterinarian immediately** if they observe persistent lameness, excessive heat, discharge, or systemic signs of illness.

DISCLAIMER

The Veterinary Professional receiving tissue shall have the sole discretion and responsibility to determine, in accordance with applicable law and professional standards, if the allograft is useable and suitable for any and all uses to which the Veterinary Professional shall transplant the allograft.

Federal (USA) law restricts this product to use by or on the order of a licensed veterinarian.

REFERENCES

FDA CVM Guidance for Industry #218: Cell-based Products for Animal Use.

FDA CVM Guidance for Industry #253: Current Good Manufacturing Practice for Animal Cells, Tissues, and Cell- and Tissue-Based Products.

FDA CVM Guidance for Industry #254: Donor Eligibility for Animal Cells, Tissues, and Cell- and Tissue-Based Products.

Bertone AL, Reinemeyer C, Tsaprailis G, Ragland D, Leise B. Cryopreserved equine umbilical cord tissue allograft characterization and biocompatibility in vivo in musculoskeletal tissues: a controlled study. BMC Med. 2025;23(1):439. Published 2025 Jul 23. doi:10.1186/s12916-025-04231-7

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